

The Japan Shopping List

Fold it into your passport. Tick things off as you go.

KONBINI Convenience stores

- ☐ Regional KitKat and seasonal chocolate
- ☐ Senbei and rice crackers (flat, travel well)
- ☐ Instant coffee jar or tea bags
- ☐ Soft candy and mochi-style chews
- ☐ Furikake and seasoning packets (no meat)

100-YEN SHOP Daiso, Seria, Can Do

- ☐ Kitchen tools: grater, sesame grinder, silicone lids
- ☐ Small plates and chopstick rests
- ☐ Stationery: pens, sticky notes, sticker sheets
- ☐ Beauty tools: blotting paper, brushes, nail files
- ☐ Foldable storage boxes for the suitcase

DRUGSTORE Cosmetics and skincare only

- ☐ Cleansing oil or balm
- ☐ Sheet masks (packs of 5 or 30)
- ☐ Hand cream and lip balm
- ☐ Hair treatment and hair oil
- ☐ Sunscreen (see the note at the bottom)

BEFORE YOU PAY Quick checks

- ☐ Ask about tax-free at the register (passport needed)
- ☐ Keep some cash for small shops
- ☐ Japanese L is closer to a US S or M
- ☐ Shoes are sized in centimetres
- ☐ Buy flat things; suitcase space runs out first

DO NOT PACK THESE

- × Anything with meat, including instant noodles, curry and soup stock
- × Beef or pork jerky and meat snacks
- × Fresh fruit, vegetables, plants and seeds
- × Whole eggs and egg products (Canada and Australia)
- × Milk and milk-based products (UK), and rice (US)

Declare all food, wherever you land. Declared items that are not allowed are simply taken away; undeclared items can mean a fine. Australia can issue an infringement notice of up to A\$7,280 and cancel your visa, but does not penalise you if you declare.

Canada caps most food categories at 20 kg or 20 L per person. Great Britain allows fish up to 20 kg and honey up to 2 kg, but no meat or milk products from outside the EU.

Sunscreen is approved under different rules in each country, so a Japanese sunscreen is not automatically better or safer for you.

This list does not cover Japanese medicines. Painkillers, eye drops and stomach remedies may contain ingredients not approved where you live.

Check the official customs page for your own country before you fly: cbp.gov, gov.uk, inspection.canada.ca or agriculture.gov.au.

